Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Pp Qq

# The Letters P and Q

P has one sound. Q almost always comes with U.

Consonants · 2 letters

## Pp The Letter P one sound

### 1 The sound of P

/p/
Close your lips, then let the air pop out

pan pot cap

### 2 When is P silent?

**P is silent in a few words.**

receipt cupboard

Grey letter = silent

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

### 3 P with other letters

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ph | /f/ | phone | photo | graph | ● ALMOST ALWAYS |
| pp | /p/ | supper | pepper | copper | ● ALWAYS |

The Letters P and Q (continued)

## Qq The Letter Q always with U

### 4 The sound of Q

/kw/
Q and U together

quick quiet question

**In English words, Q is almost always followed by U.**

● ALMOST ALWAYS

Names from other languages can be different:
**Iraq · Qatar**

### 5 When is Q silent?

Q is never silent.

### 6 Q with other letters

que /k/ unique antique
At the end of a word.

● ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

# The Letter R

Rr

R is a consonant. In American English we always say it, and it changes the vowel before it.

Consonant · 1 sound

## 1 The sound of R

**/r/**
Round your lips; your tongue does not touch the top

**r**un **r**ock **r**est

**In American English, we always say the R — even at the end of a word.**

ca**r** fa**r** wate**r**

● ALWAYS

## 2 When is R silent?

R is never silent in American English.

## 3 R with other letters

**ar** — /ɑːr/ c**ar** p**ar**k f**ar**m
After W it is different: w**ar** · w**ar**m
● USUALLY TRUE

**or** — /ɔːr/ f**or** c**or**n f**or**k
After W it is different: w**or**d · w**or**k
● USUALLY TRUE

**er** — /ɜː/ t**er**m v**er**b p**er**son
/ə/ wat**er** teach**er** numb**er**
At the end of a word, ER is weak: /ə/.
● USUALLY TRUE

The Letter R (continued)

## 3 R with other letters (continued)

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **ir** | /ɜː/ | bird | first | shirt | ● ALMOST ALWAYS |
| **ur** | /ɜː/ | turn | burn | fur | ● ALMOST ALWAYS |
| | ER, IR and UR often sound the same. | | | | |
| **air** | /er/ | hair | chair | fair | ● ALWAYS |
| **are** | /er/ | care | share | scare | ● ALMOST ALWAYS |
| | One very common word is different: are /ɑːr/ | | | | |
| **ear** | /ɪr/ | near | hear | clear | ● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD |
| | /er/ | bear | wear | pear | |
| | /ɜː/ | learn | earth | early | |
| **eer** | /ɪr/ | deer | cheer | career | ● ALWAYS |
| **rr** | /r/ | carry | sorry | mirror | ● ALWAYS |

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

# The Letter S

S is a consonant with two sounds. With H it makes a new sound.

Consonant · 2 sounds

## 1 The sounds of S

### /s/
Air hisses out, like a snake

**s**alt
**s**and
plu**s**

### /z/
Like /s/ with your voice on

i**s**
ha**s**
ea**s**y

**At the end of a word, S can say /s/ or /z/.**

cat**s** book**s** dog**s** pen**s**

● ALWAYS

After P, T, K or F: /s/. After other sounds: /z/.

## 2 When is S silent?

**S is silent in a few words.**

i**s**land

Grey letter = silent

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

## 3 S with other letters

**sh** /ʃ/ fi**sh** **sh**op ca**sh**

● ALWAYS

The Letter S (continued)

## 3 S with other letters (continued)

**ss** /s/ class glass dress — ALMOST ALWAYS

**sc** /s/ science scene scent
/sk/ scarf scan
Before E or I, SC says /s/. — USUALLY TRUE

**sion** /ʒən/ vision fusion decision
/ʃən/ tension mansion pension — NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

**es** /ɪz/ boxes buses dishes
After S, X, SH or CH, the plural ending ES says /ɪz/. — ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

# The Letter T

T is a consonant. American English has a special T between vowels.

Consonant · 1 sound

## 1 The sound of T

**/t/**
Tongue behind your top teeth, then a puff of air

top tent bat

**Between two vowels, the American T sounds like a quick, soft D.**

water later data

● USUALLY TRUE

## 2 When is T silent?

**In STEN and STLE, T is silent.**

lis**t**en fas**t**en cas**t**le

Grey letter = silent

● USUALLY TRUE

## 3 T with other letters

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| th | /θ/ | think | three | math |
| | /ð/ | this | that | them |

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| tch | /tʃ/ | watch | catch | kitchen |

● ALWAYS

The Letter T (continued)

## 3 T with other letters (continued)

**tion** /ʃən/ station nation action

One common word is different: question

● ALMOST ALWAYS

**ture** /tʃəɹ/ picture future nature

● ALWAYS

**tt** /t/ letter better bottom

● ALWAYS

**bt** /t/ doubt debt

The B is silent.

● ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

# The Letters V and W

V and W have one sound each. W makes new sounds with other letters.

Consonants · 2 letters

## Vv The Letter V one sound

### 1 The sound of V

**/v/**
Top teeth on your bottom lip, voice on

van vest seven

**English words almost never end in V. We add a silent E.**

have give live

ALMOST ALWAYS

### 2 When is V silent?

V is never silent.

## Ww The Letter W one sound

### 3 The sound of W

**/w/**
Round your lips like a small O

wet win web

The Letters V and W (continued)

## 4 When is W silent?

**W is silent in a few words.**

t**w**o  ans**w**er

Grey letter = silent

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

## 5 W with other letters

**wh** — /w/ **wh**at **wh**en **wh**ite

But: who · whole say /h/.

● USUALLY TRUE

**wr** — /r/ **wr**ite **wr**ong **wr**ap

At the start of a word, the W is silent.

● ALWAYS

**aw** — /ɑː/ s**aw** dr**aw** l**aw**

● ALMOST ALWAYS

**ew** — /uː/ n**ew** gr**ew** fl**ew**

Sometimes /juː/: few

● USUALLY TRUE

**ow** — /oʊ/ sn**ow** sl**ow** gr**ow**

/aʊ/ n**ow** c**ow** t**ow**n

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Xx Yy

# The Letters X and Y

X makes two sounds at once. Y can be a consonant or a vowel.

Consonants · 2 letters

## Xx The Letter X two sounds together

### 1 The sounds of X

**/ks/**
Two sounds together — /k/ and /s/

six
fox
taxi

**/gz/**
Two sounds together — /g/ and /z/

exam
exact
example

### 2 When is X silent?

X is almost never silent.

The Letters X and Y (continued)

## Yy The Letter Y a consonant and a vowel

### 3 The sounds of Y

| /j/ | /aɪ/ | /i/ | /ɪ/ |
|---|---|---|---|
| At the start of a word | Long I — end of a short word | Like E — end of a long word | Like short I |
| yes | my | happy | myth |
| yellow | fly | candy | system |
| yard | why | lucky | symbol |

**After C or G, Y works like E or I.**
C says /s/ and G says /dʒ/.

fancy cycle gym energy

● USUALLY TRUE

### 4 When is Y silent?

Y is almost never silent on its own.

### 5 Y with other letters

**ay** /eɪ/ day play say
But: says

● ALMOST ALWAYS

**ey** /i/ valley honey turkey
/iː/ key
/eɪ/ they obey

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

**oy** /ɔɪ/ toy joy enjoy

● ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y **Z**




# The Letter Z

Z is the last letter of the alphabet. It has one sound.

Consonant · 1 sound

## 1 The sound of Z

**/z/**
Like /s/ with your voice on

zoo · zero · lazy

## 2 When is Z silent?

Z is never silent.

## 3 Z with other letters

**zz** /z/ — buzz · jazz · fizz

One common word is different: pizza says /ts/.

● ALMOST ALWAYS

/ə/

# All the Sounds of American English

Every sound you learned in this book, with a word you know.

## 1 Short vowels

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| /æ/ | cat | /e/ | bed | /ɪ/ | sit | /ɑː/ | hot |
| /ʌ/ | cup | /ʊ/ | book | /ə/ | about | | |

## 2 Long vowels and two-part vowels

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| /iː/ | me | /eɪ/ | day | /aɪ/ | my | /oʊ/ | go |
| /uː/ | food | /aʊ/ | out | /ɔɪ/ | oil | | |

## 3 Vowels with R

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| /ɑːr/ | car | /ɔːr/ | for | /ɝː/ | bird | /ɚ/ | water |
| /er/ | hair | /ɪr/ | near | | | | |

## 4 Consonants

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| /p/ | pan | /b/ | bell | /t/ | top | /d/ | desk |
| /k/ | kid | /g/ | gas | /f/ | fan | /v/ | van |
| /θ/ | think | /ð/ | this | /s/ | salt | /z/ | zoo |
| /ʃ/ | fish | /ʒ/ | vision | /tʃ/ | chip | /dʒ/ | job |
| /m/ | milk | /n/ | net | /ŋ/ | ring | /h/ | hat |
| /l/ | lamp | /r/ | run | /w/ | wet | /j/ | yes |